

THE LANGUAGE OF RHYTHM: BINARY GRID

Book: "The Rhythm Code" by Tamas Bodzsar · The foundational notation system

Rhythm = WHERE notes START, not how long they last

Traditional music schools teach rhythm **VALUES** (duration: whole note, quarter note, eighth note).

The Rhythm Code teaches rhythm **PLACEMENT** — which of the 8 positions in a measure does a note start on?

Binary system: **1 = a note starts here** · **0 = no note starts here**

THE 8-POSITION GRID

A 4/4 measure divided into 8 positions — the 8th note is the smallest unit



Downbeats (1, 2, 3, 4) — the 4 main beats, heavy and grounded **Upbeats** (+) — the "and" between beats, light and forward-pulling

Same grid works at ANY tempo — we always use the 8th-note grid regardless of speed

READING BINARY NOTATION — TWO EXAMPLES

EXAMPLE A — BEAT 1 ONLY

10000000



Note starts on beat 1 only. Could be a whole note or a short 8th note — both look identical in binary.

EXAMPLE B — BEAT 2 ONLY

00100000



Note starts on beat 2 only. Duration doesn't matter — only the starting position is recorded.

THE FUNDAMENTAL RULE

A long whole note and a short 8th note are **IDENTICAL** in binary notation — both show a single 1 at their starting position. Duration is irrelevant to the Rhythm Code system. Only WHERE notes start determines the rhythmic quality of music.

POSITION NAMES REFERENCE

POS 1	POS 2	POS 3	POS 4	POS 5	POS 6	POS 7	POS 8
Beat 1	And 1	Beat 2	And 2	Beat 3	And 3	Beat 4	And 4

RHYTHM CODE OS · MODULE A